



MC Competitive Snapshot | July Edition

It's been a quiet month for competitor announcements: mostly some incremental summer releases plus a familiar face stepping in as CEO at Iterable, and a collection of new Braze compete materials!

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Competitive News You Can Use

Adobe Journey Optimizer's June release is mostly catchup capabilities

[RCS messaging](#) is GA in AJO. Other updates in limited release: content decisioning, journey testing + pause/resume.

 **So what:** Outside of RCS, this release doesn't really move the needle. They're trying to close journey feature gaps, but most of the new features are still in limited release, meanwhile MCE already has those capabilities.

HubSpot's June Release: more 'good enough' features for mid-market teams

1) Salesforce ↔ HubSpot custom object sync now in **Public Beta**. Private beta in Feb 2024. It's still in beta, but now it's **public** ✨ beta.

⚡ Enterprise tier only.

⚡ Limit 10 custom objects.

New Fit + Engagement lead scoring models are live.

⚡ Still limited to HubSpot data.

⚡ No 3rd-party or real-time data.

Facebook Conversions API + deal stage sync to improve targeting.

⚡ Facebook only. No LinkedIn, Google, or other ad platforms.

⚡ No multi-touch visibility across the journey.

🔥 Syncs with Contacts or Leads, but not both.

🔥 Based on deal stage only; not real-time or behavior based.

🎨 Iterable: Former Salesforce Chief Pipeline Officer hired as CEO

Iterable just named Sam Allen--formerly Salesforce's Chief Pipeline Officer--as CEO. Founder Andrew Boni is staying on board, becoming Chief Scientist to focus on Nova, their not-yet-launched AI agent.

He follows new CRO, CFO, and Head of Product Marketing hires, signaling a push toward enterprise scale and rigor. Maybe even prep for IPO or acquisition?

They also launched a new "[Ditch the Cult](#)" campaign urging marketers to ditch batch-and-blast for 1:1 moments-based marketing.

⚠️ **Heads up:** With a Salesforce alum as CEO and a new challenger narrative, Iterable is probably going to target the MC install base as a 'modern alternative.' But Sam left before we launched MCE+, so if they paint us as complex or disconnected, it's based on old news, not our next-gen platform.

🖨 Klaviyo: AI Service Agent in public beta

[AI Service Agent](#), part of Klaviyo Service, ingests info from Shopify + manually-uploaded knowledge articles to answer questions in the Klaviyo Customer Hub chat.

- 🔥 Knowledge must be manually loaded and refined
- 🔥 No email, SMS, in-app, BYOC or agent assist tools
- 🔥 Can't customize brand voice, tone, or style
- 🔥 No in-session task automation (e.g., issuing refunds, canceling orders, modifying subscriptions)
- 🔥 No triggered actions across systems
- 🔥 No real-time personalization or action chaining

Example on right: Klaviyo AI Service Agent can't answer a basic question like "What time does your store open?"

Chat

AI assistant
Hello! How can I assist you today?

What time does your store open?

AI assistant
I'm sorry, I don't know how to answer that. Would you like me to connect you with an agent?

Yes, connect me with an agent.

No, do not connect me.

Ask a question

For You Orders Chat Profile

Competitive Win Story

\$500K+ Cross-Cloud Win Replacing Braze

We initially lost to The Children's Place (TCP) in an RFP because of pricing, but they came back after realizing Braze couldn't deliver what they promised.

TCP was frustrated by limited personalization; disconnected campaign setup; and a manual, IT-led process for building segments.

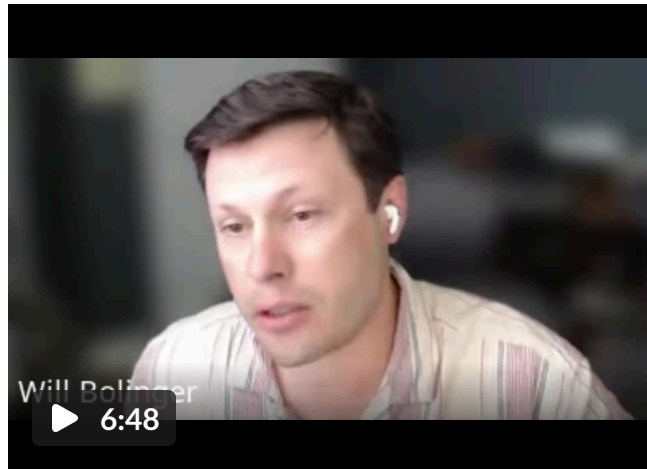
They asked us to help them build a single view of the customer so they can deliver personalized, omnichannel experiences centered around loyalty.

They were so bought in, they moved their Braze migration up by 5 months just to get started faster



🏆 Why We Won 🏆

- Journey Builder + drag-and-drop segmentation demo wowed marketing users.
 - *"This is incredible. I want this."*
- Replaced multiple tools with one connected stack: MCE, CC, DC, and Loyalty.
- MCE + Data Cloud enables deep, household-level personalization across loyalty, purchase, and behavioral signals.
- Excited for MC Next SKUs after seeing our announcements at CNX.



"We were painted this picture that Braze was going to be easy to use. And it's not."



Braze Pain Points

- Segmentation had to **go through IT via Redshift**; then manually uploaded spreadsheets to Braze.
- **No real-time or unified data** → no easy access to loyalty, purchase, or household data in Braze.
- **Personalization was nearly impossible** → Couldn't recognize households or tailor to buyer behavior.
- **Spray-and-pray** → **3–6 batch emails per day** from multiple tools that didn't talk to each other.
- Braze pitched a marketer-friendly UI, but TCP couldn't **self-serve segmentation or dynamically tailor content based on households/families**.

Congrats to [@Kelsey Warshaw](#) [@Will Bolinger](#) [@Andy Diman](#) [@Taylor Remsen](#) [@Jason Foster](#) for this Braze winback!

New for June

Braze Compete Hub

Courtesy of our CI team: Brand new [Braze Canvas](#) tons of fresh intel, including a competitive overview, [new Field Guide](#), Sales Agent prompts, and product FAQs

Rapid Fire Braze Enablement Recording

We hosted a 30-minute [rapid fire style enablement](#) session on how to beat Braze covering:

- Win/Loss insights
- Marketing Cloud differentiators
- How to deposition their top four strengths: Ease of Use, Real-Time Personalization, Mobile, Data Platform
- Win stories from GoodRx and The Children's Place

 [Rapid Fire Recording here](#)

 [Full competitive enablement deck](#)

PLUS a fully-loaded [NotebookLM](#) with Braze vs. MCE+ content. Ping [@Holly Jackson](#) for access issues.

Confidential & Internal Only

Rapid Fire: Reality Behind Braze Strengths

	Braze	MC Advanced / MCE+
Ease of Use	Easy to start. Hard to scale. For advanced use cases, you'll need technical or dev help to prep and use the right data	More setup = more marketer control Bigger learning curve because it can do more. Once setup, marketers can build journeys, personalize content, and activate across channels without IT.
Real Time Personalization	Event-based, short memory Optimized for real-time events but has a 30-day limit on historical custom event logic. No full journey context without a CDP or data extensions.	Real-time contextualized personalization Combines real-time signals + full history + calculated insights for more relevant personalization.
Mobile	Mobile-first, real-time engagement Web, social, and ad personalization require add-ons and third party tools	Full-funnel lifecycle orchestration Built for full-funnel orchestration across email, SMS, web, ads, social, mobile, etc.
Data	Activation layer, not a real CDP Needs Segment, Snowflake, mParticle, or a data warehouse/CDP to unify and prep external data.	Built on a native CDP Unifies first-party, third-party, structured, and unstructured data all in one platform.

Deal Makers & Breakers

Top competitive tips of the month | **BRAZE EDITION**

[@Kelsey Warshaw](#) and [@Will Bolinger](#)'s tips for Braze competes.

1 Braze personalization is only as good as the data behind it. If they're just using Braze opens, clicks, and channel data, that's a small slice of the customer. Data Cloud gives them full profiles and even household-level views. When you dig into what they *think* they're doing in Braze, it usually exposes a lot of their shortcomings.

2 Braze doesn't have a CDP. They're using Redshift, Segment, or some other partner for that. We can say, "Hey, you're already using XYZ with Salesforce. Here's how easy and cheap it is to bring in just the data you

need.” No need for a full lift-and-shift.

3 Make the case for DC. Getting to engagement data in MCE isn’t always easy. Einstein can help, but deeper targeting usually requires SQL. But if you set up Data Cloud upfront, that data flows in automatically. Then it’s a lot easier to go build the audiences you want.

IN CASE YOU MISSED IT

Check out June's [Competitive Snapshot](#) here!

[Marketing Cloud Resource Hub](#)

One-stop-shop for all MC Resources

[Marketing Cloud Slack Channel Guide](#)

Know where to go for resources & questions

[Marketing Cloud Sales Plays](#)

Top plays, run-rate plays, and more!

[Marketing Cloud Vault](#)

Toolkit for customer engagement

Channels

- [#help-competitive-marketingcloud](#)
 - [#help-competitive-adobe](#)
 - [#help-competitive-hubspot](#)
 - [#help-competitive-braze](#)
 - [#help-competitive-data-360](#)
 - [#help-competitive-oracle](#)
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Canvas Owner: [@Holly Jackson](#), Marketing Cloud PMM, Market Strategy

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